

Fig no 1.3 Food Guide for planning a balanced diet

In order to plan balanced meals for people, the foods we use in our daily meals are classified into four basic food groups: on the basis of the major nutrients present. The food groups are chosen because of the specific nutrients contributed by each to the total diet. This practical tool devised to guide food selection to meet nutritional needs is termed **'Food Guide'.**

A food guide is a practical tool in meal planning and evaluation

It's a guide that helps us to make healthy food choices

It tells us all the food groups our bodies need and how many servings of each group we need

How to plan a meal with the help of the Food Guide?

- ❖ Include foods from each of the four broad food groups
- ❖ Choose the minimum number of servings from each group
- ❖ Make choices with in each group
- ❖ Include one food from the protein group in each meal
- ❖ Use seasonal foods

1.3 MEAL PLANNING

Any individual who carries the responsibility of providing meals has to take decisions regarding what to serve, how much to serve, how much to spend, where to shop, how much to buy, how to prepare food, how to serve meals and at what hour to serve the meal. All such decisions are a part of planning meals. Extending this concept further, one could define meal planning as a simple practical exercise which involves applying the knowledge of food, nutrient requirement, and individual preferences to plan adequate and acceptable meals. In other terms, **meal planning means planning for adequate nutrition.**



Meal planning means planning diets which will provide all nutrients in required amounts and proportions i.e. adequate nutrition.

As the family's well-being and health are depended on how well they are fed. It is a challenge to every meal-planner to meet it and when well done, it proves to be a satisfying and rewarding experience.

Meal planning thus is both an art and a science: **art** in the skillful blending of colors, texture, and flavor: and **science** in the wise choice of food for optimum nutrition and digestion.

1.3.1 Objectives of Meal planning

1. To satisfy the nutritional needs of the family members.

Unit 1 RECOMMENDED DIETARY ALLOWANCE AND MEAL PLANNING.indd 6 1/19/2020 2:51:02 PM